

IT Internship Assessment: AI & Workflow Automation Strategy

1. Assessment Overview

This document outlines the evaluation framework for the IT Internship role, focusing on AI-driven process automation. The assessment measures the ability to rapidly conceptualize, build, and explain a functional workflow using **n8n** and **Generative AI**.

The evaluation is time-boxed to a **one-day (24-hour) turnaround**, simulating a real-world scenario where agility and rapid prototyping are essential. Following the submission, a **live screenshare session** will be conducted to review the logic, execution, and functionality of the solution.

2. Logistics & Access

- **Timeline:** The assessment is to be completed within 24 hours of receipt.
- **Platform Access:** Access credentials for the n8n automation platform will be provided.
- **Review Format:** A live screenshare session is required. During this session, the workflow must be executed in real-time, and the logic explained to the reviewer.

3. Assessment Use-Case Options

The assessment requires the selection and implementation of **one** of the following three automation objectives. The focus should be on achieving the core objective using n8n and a free AI API.

Option 1 — IT Support Ticket Triage

- **Context:** High volumes of unclassified support emails causing delays.
- **Objective:** Create a workflow that reads incoming ticket content, utilizes AI to classify the issue category and severity, and routes it to the correct internal destination.

Option 2 — HR Onboarding Document Verification

- **Context:** Manual cross-referencing of new hire documents against application data.
- **Objective:** Create a workflow that extracts text from a provided document/image, utilizes AI to verify that the details match a specific dataset, and automates the approval/rejection notification.

Option 3 — Client Meeting Summaries & Action Items

- **Context:** Inconsistent manual notes from client calls leading to missed follow-ups.
- **Objective:** Create a workflow that takes a raw meeting transcript, utilizes AI to structure a professional summary and extract a list of action items, and formats them for email delivery.

4. Assessment Expectations

The assessment is designed to evaluate more than just technical execution. The following competencies are assessed:

- **Rapid Prototyping:** The ability to deliver a functional "Proof of Concept" within a tight deadline.
- **Live Demonstration:** The ability to confidently navigate the n8n interface during a screenshare, run the workflow, and troubleshoot if necessary.
- **Communication:** The ability to articulate the logic behind the workflow design and the role of AI within the process during the verbal review.
- **AI Implementation:** The effective use of free-tier AI APIs (e.g., Google Gemini) to replace manual cognitive effort (categorization, extraction, summarization).

5. Tools & Constraints

- **Workflow Platform:** Must utilize the provided n8n instance.
- **AI Integration:** Must integrate a **free-tier AI API** (Google Gemini via AI Studio or similar). Paid API keys should not be used.
- **Scope:** The solution is expected to be a functional prototype, not a production-grade application. Hard-coded sample data is acceptable if live integrations (like connecting to a real Gmail inbox) are not feasible due to security/access limits.

6. Evaluation Criteria

Reviewers will assess the performance based on the following weighted criteria:

- **Functional Execution (40%):** Does the workflow actually run? Does the AI provide a relevant output?
- **Verbal Explanation (30%):** Can the logic be clearly explained during the screenshare? Is the candidate comfortable walking through the nodes?
- **Technical Logic (15%):** Is the n8n structure sound? Are data mappings between nodes correct?
- **AI Prompt Engineering (15%):** Is the prompt structure effective in getting the desired result from the AI model?

7. Required Deliverables

The assessment requires preparation for the following deliverables at the end of the 24-hour period:

1. **A Functional n8n Workflow:** A saved, active workflow within the provided n8n instance.
2. **Live Demo Readiness:** Preparation to share the screen, trigger the workflow, and show the data flowing through the nodes in real-time.
3. **Process Walkthrough:** A verbal readiness to explain the "Why" and "How" of the solution during the call.